

The Claude Power Guide

10 ways to get dramatically better answers from Claude — the moves the other 99% never learn.

Most people type a question into Claude the way they'd type into Google. That's why they get average results. The people who get *incredible* results aren't smarter — they just know how the model actually wants to be talked to. This short guide hands you those moves. Read it once, keep it nearby, and steal the copy-paste template near the end.

Inside: the one idea that changes everything · 10 power moves with examples · a fill-in-the-blanks prompt template · a 30-second pre-send checklist.

First, the one idea that changes everything

Claude is not a search engine. It's a brilliant, literal-minded assistant who does **exactly** what you ask — no more, no less. It can't read your mind, it can't see your screen, and it assumes nothing you didn't say. So the whole game is this: **give it the context and the shape of the answer you want, before you ask the question.** Every tip below is a version of that one idea.

1. Give it a role, a goal, and the rules — not just a question

Compare “write me a cold email” with the version below. The second wins every time, because you've told Claude *who to be, what success looks like, and what to avoid.*

You are a B2B sales copywriter. Write a 90-word cold email to a construction company owner. Goal: book a 15-min call. Rules: no jargon, one clear CTA, friendly not salesy.

2. Structure longer prompts with tags

Claude was trained to recognise simple labelled sections. Once a prompt grows past a sentence or two, wrap each part in plain tags so nothing blurs together with your instruction:

```
<context> We build luxury homes in Ooty. </context>
<task> Draft 3 Instagram captions. </task>
<rules> Under 30 words. Include one emoji. </rules>
```

3. Show an example of what “good” looks like

Telling Claude the format helps. *Showing* it is far stronger. Paste one example of the output you want — one good tweet, one good summary, one line in your brand voice — and say “match this style.” This is the single highest-leverage trick in the guide. One example beats three paragraphs of description.

4. Ask for a plan before the work

For anything complex, add: “Before you write, think step by step and outline your approach, then do it.” Letting Claude reason first sharply improves accuracy on logic, math, code, and multi-part tasks. You can read the plan, fix it, and only then let it run — saving a dozen bad drafts.

5. Start its answer for it

You can put the first words in Claude's mouth to lock the format. Want pure JSON with no chit-chat? End with “Respond only with the JSON, starting with {”. Want a table? Say “Begin your answer with the table.” Control the opening and you control the whole response.

6. Give it permission to say “I don't know”

Models guess when cornered. One line fixes most of it: “If you're not sure, say so instead of guessing.” Add “only use the information I gave you” when you've pasted a document and want answers grounded in it, not in the model's memory.

7. Treat it like a colleague, not a vending machine

The magic is in the second and third message, not the first. Don't restart — reply. "Tighter." "More formal." "Now turn that into a LinkedIn post." Better yet, make it grade its own work: "Critique your draft as a tough editor, then rewrite it." Quality jumps in one step.

8. Stop re-explaining yourself — use Projects

In Claude, a **Project** holds custom instructions and reference files that apply to every chat inside it. Put your business details, tone of voice, and do's and don'ts there once. Now every conversation already knows who you are — no more pasting the same background every morning.

9. Feed it your files, screenshots, and PDFs

Claude reads documents and images. Drop in a PDF contract and ask "what are the risky clauses?" Paste a screenshot of a spreadsheet and ask "what's the trend?" Upload a messy statement and ask for a clean summary table. Most people retype everything; you can just hand it the file.

10. Ask Claude to write the prompt for you

The ultimate move. When stuck, say: "I want to achieve X. Ask me any questions you need, then write the perfect prompt I should give you." It interviews you and hands back a better prompt than you'd have written. You're now using the model to get better at using the model.

The copy-paste template

Keep this nearby. Fill in the blanks and you've applied tips 1, 2, 3, 4 and 6 in one shot:

You are a [ROLE].

<context>

[Everything Claude needs – who I am, the situation, the audience.]

</context>

<task>

[Exactly what I want you to produce.]

</task>

<rules>

- [Length / format] - [Tone]

- If unsure about anything, ask me before you start.

</rules>

Here is an example of the style I want: [paste one good example]

First outline your approach, then produce the final result.

The 30-second checklist

Before you hit send, did you...	Why it matters
Say who Claude should be?	Sets expertise and tone
Give the context it can't guess?	It assumes nothing
Show one example of "good"?	Beats any description
State length & format?	Usable output, not an essay
Allow "I don't know"?	Kills confident wrong answers

Now go use it

You're already ahead of almost everyone who touches these tools. Pick **one** tip and use it on your very next prompt — the role-and-rules move (Tip 1) is the fastest win. Then add the next. Within a week this way of talking to Claude feels automatic, and you'll quietly be getting output other people can't figure out how you made.

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